

lawyers and accountants, because it needs honest books and written agreements and established, stable laws. You don't have them in China yet.

The Japanese market advanced more than three hundred-fold after 1950. That miracle can be reenacted in China.

But law and accountancy are coming. Country after country has seen the advantages of moving toward free markets, less government intervention, and lower taxes. These things work. They've worked in China, with particularly spectacular results, in the Special Economic Zones in the south. It would be very hard now to reverse the process and go back to a government-monopoly economy, because people have enjoyed upgrading from a bicycle to a motorcycle, from a radio to a color TV. What's more, the consumer revolution will lead to a political evolution toward a greater measure of democracy in China.

China Roused

Napoleon said, "Let China sleep, for when it wakes, it will shake the world." China went to sleep in the early fifteenth century. Back then its technology, culture, and government were far ahead of those of European, Indian, or Ottoman civilizations. But the Ming emperors cut off all contact with the West and sank back into complacent isolation. That was not a good long-run plan.